

Introduction

I grew more interested in pursuing technical writing as a career by writing about my favorite video game, Final Fantasy XIV. I wanted to help newer players understand aspects of the game they may find complicated.

The Astrologian job previously used a stance system to change the effects of certain spells and abilities. As Astrologian has been my favorite job to play, I wrote this to explain how the stances (known as Sects) worked. I covered both what spells and abilities were affected by a Sect and how those Sects applied to playing with other healer jobs.

As of the Endwalker expansion, this system has been removed from the game. However, I'm proud of my work on this piece.

Astrologian Sects

In Final Fantasy 14, the Astrologian gains access to two different stances known as **sects**. These sects change how your spells affect other players. You cannot cast these spells without having a sect active, and you can't change your active sect in the middle of combat. It's important to know what they do and how they affect your healing!

Diurnal Sect



You gain the ability **Diurnal Sect** at level 30 when you unlock the Astrologian job. Diurnal Sect adds Regen effects to certain spells. Spells with these effects heal an additional amount at intervals over a short stretch of time.

Let's use the spell Aspected Benefic as an example. The spell heals the target, and its Cure Potency is 200 (half the power of your primary healing spell, Benefic). When you cast it in Diurnal Sect, you also grant the target the Aspected Benefic buff. This heals them again for the same Cure Potency at short intervals. The effect lasts for 15 seconds.

Diurnal Sect effects are helpful when you're healing a target taking consistent hits from an enemy over time (such as the normal hits a tank takes from a boss).

Nocturnal Sect



You gain the ability **Nocturnal Sect** at level 50 after completing the Astrologian job quest "Loved By The Sun." Nocturnal Sect adds Damage Reduction effects to certain spells. Buffs from these spells nullify some of the incoming damage a target will take from a hit.

Let's use Aspected Benefic again as an example. As before, the spell heals the target with a Cure Potency of 200. When you cast it in Nocturnal Sect, you also grant the target the Nocturnal Field effect. Nocturnal Field nullifies incoming damage a character takes, equal to 250% of the HP the spell healed for. It can last for up to 30 seconds, though it can disappear much sooner depending on how much damage the target takes.

Nocturnal Sect effects are incredibly helpful in mitigating damage from an unavoidable attack (such as an area-wide attack).

The Nocturnal Field effect cannot be stacked with the Galvanize effect applied by certain Scholar spells.

Spells and Abilities Affected by Sects

Certain Astrologian spells and abilities are affected by Diurnal and Nocturnal Sect. These can be powerful tools in your healing arsenal. The following list showcases those spells and abilities, along with their effects in each sect.

Cure Potency dictates the relative strength of the healing spell or ability. For comparison, an Astrologian's Benefic spell has a Cure Potency of 500.



At level 34, you gain the spell **Aspected Benefic**. Aspected benefic instantly heals a single target with a Cure Potency of 200.

In Diurnal Sect, it applies the Aspected Benefic regen effect to the target. This heals the target with a Cure Potency of 200 multiple times over 15 seconds.

In Nocturnal Sect, it applies the Nocturnal Field effect to the target, which nullifies 250% of the amount of HP healed.



At level 42, you gain the spell **Aspected Helios**. Aspected Helios heals you and all nearby party members within a certain area. This spell has a Cure Potency of 200.

In Diurnal Sect, it applies the Aspected Helios regen effect to you and all nearby party members. This heals each target with a Cure Potency of 100 multiple times over 15 seconds.

In Nocturnal Sect, it applies the Nocturnal Field effect to you and all nearby party members.



You gain the ability **Collective Unconscious** at level 58 after completing the Astrologian job quest "Trumped." Collective Unconscious creates a bubble around you, providing a regen effect (Cure Potency of 100) and a damage reduction effect (reduces 10% of incoming damage) to all party members inside the bubble. The bubble dissipates after 18 seconds or earlier if you move.

In Diurnal Sect, the regen effect persists for 15 seconds after the bubble dissipates. The damage reduction effect ends once the bubble dissipates.

In Nocturnal Sect, the damage reduction effect persists for 20 seconds after the bubble dissipates. It disappears once a party member is hit. The regen effect ends once the bubble dissipates.



You gain the ability **Celestial Opposition** at level 60 after completing the Astrologian job quest “The Hands of Fate.” Celestial Opposition instantly heals you and all nearby party members within a certain area. This ability has a Cure Potency of 200.

In Diurnal Sect, it applies a regen effect to you and all nearby party members that heals each target with a Cure Potency of 100 multiple times over 15 seconds.

In Nocturnal Sect, it applies a damage reduction effect to that nullifies 125% of the amount of HP healed. Unlike Nocturnal Field, this effect can be stacked with the Scholar’s Galvanize effect.



At level 74, you gain the ability **Celestial Intersection**. Celestial Intersection heals a single target with a Cure Potency of 200.

In Diurnal Sect, it applies a damage reduction effect to the target, nullifying damage equal to 200% of the amount of HP healed.

In Nocturnal Sect, it applies a regen effect that heals the target with a Cure Potency of 150 multiple times over 15 seconds.

Neutral Sect



At level 80, you gain the ability **Neutral Sect**. This 20 second effect boosts your healing magic potency by 20% and allows you to use both Diurnal and Nocturnal Sects with certain spells. Specifically, Neutral Sect allows Aspected Benefic and Aspected Helios to grant targets both the Diurnal and Nocturnal additional effects. Your allies gain both regen and damage reduction!

Sects and Other Healers

When you’re working with another healer in a full party of 8 members, your active Sect matters more. This is especially true if your fellow healer is another Astrologian. *If both Astrologians have the same Sect active, their spell effects will cancel each other out.* Check which Sect your fellow Astrologian has active, and change your active Sect if needed.



Scholars have spells that apply the Galvanize effect, which cannot be stacked with the Nocturnal Field effect gained in Nocturnal Sect. Switch to Diurnal Sect to keep your spell effects from cancelling out your Scholar’s.



White Mage spells don’t have any spell effects that will cancel out your Astrologian effects. However, what sect you have active can make all the difference. In lower-level duties, a Diurnal Astrologian and a White Mage can use their combined regen effects to bring a party back from near death. In higher-level duties, a Nocturnal Astrologian can reduce the damage party members take while the White Mage’s regen-effects bring their health back up.

Remember, you can only change your active Sect outside of combat. Consider your situation and choose your Sect accordingly!